DOG BITE CASES IN DELHI



54
Rabies deaths in 2024 across India; one death for every 68,836 dog bites

3,715,713
Reported dog bite cases in India in 2024, a 22 per cent increase since 2023

How does the world do it?



UNITED STATES

Animal control agencies and shelters/ rescue groups follow no-kill protocols, spay/ neuter campaigns. Nationwide vaccination laws have nearly wiped out canine rabies

EUROPE

Western, Northern Europe have virtually eliminated homeless dogs by registration, neutering, anti-abandonment laws, free or highly subsidised spaying/ neutering



"It is not a doable order.... You'll have to find 3,000 places where no one lives"

MANEKA GANDHI
Former Union minister, animal rights activist



"People are fed up of stray dogs.... The SC's directions are important. We want to provide relief..."

REKHA GUPTA
Chief Minister, Delhi

WHY ARE ANIMAL WELFARE GROUPS PROTESTING?

They say the SC order undoes decades of sterilisation; adopts a method the world has moved away from while rejecting the scientifically proven/ humane ABC solution

RABIES DEATHS

While rabies is fatal, it can be prevented if vaccine is administered soon after a bite. There are vaccines for dogs to keep them rabies-free. Most bite cases do not lead to rabies. Before Chhavi Sharma, Delhi has had zero rabies death since 2022. There are 14 states with no rabies cases in the past two years

THE SOLUTION

India follows the globally accepted Animal Birth Control (ABC) method to regulate the population of strays through sterilisation

MCD'S FAILURE

Unlike in Jaipur, Visakhapatnam and Bengaluru, the MCD's rate of sterilisation/ vaccination of around 10,000 is far below the prescribed 70-80 per cent to balance Delhi's dog population of around a million (last surveyed officially in 2009)

THE CENTRE'S STAND

"The intensive implementation of the ABC programme by local bodies is the only rational and scientific solution..."— a statement issued to Parliament in April 2025

W.H.O. BATS FOR ABC

"There is no evidence that removal of dogs has a significant impact on dog population...or the spread of rabies"

CHALLENGES

- Money: Delhi's health budget is Rs 12,893 crore; estimated cost of SC-ordered exercise is Rs 10,000 crore
- Limited land, labour; overcrowding
- SC's no-release order may require changing of ABC Rules

WHERE DELHI STANDS

- No permanent govt/ MCD dog shelters in Delhi
- 20 ABC centres run by MCD and NGOs for post-sterilisation holding of 2,500-4,000 dogs, not for housing